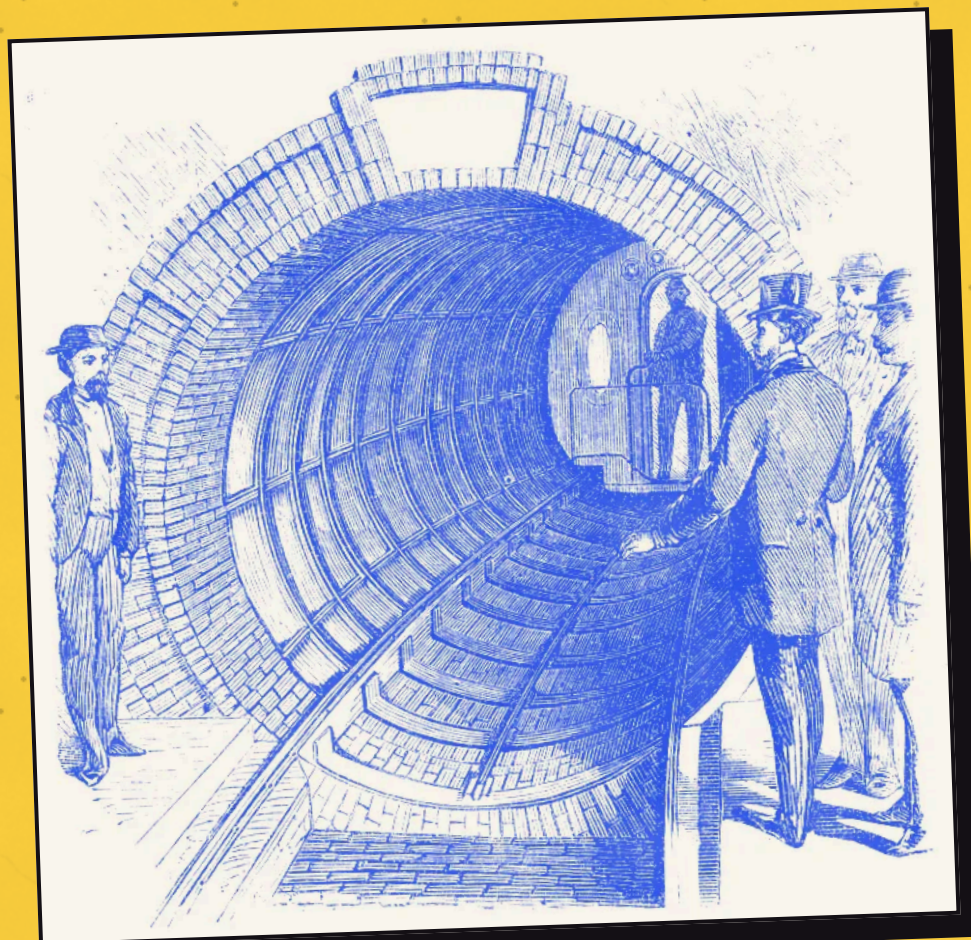


THE STARTER DECK

FREE

Eighteen free printable cards from history's near-misses, myths and true stories that sound made up. Happened, almost, or lore?



EIGHTEEN CLAIMS TO START AN ARGUMENT

Every card is a claim written as plain fact. Stamp it **happened**, **almost** or **lore**, then flip it and read the record.

● HAPPENED

Every name, number, date and place is right, exactly as written.

C ALMOST

It didn't happen — but the paperwork shows it came close.

* LORE

A story everybody repeats that the record doesn't support.

THE QUICKEST GAME

One reader, five cards, everyone else calls a verdict. Score out of five: 0 Hollywood Screenwriter, 1 Uncle at Thanksgiving, 2 Tour Guide, 3 Pub Quizzer, 4 Historian, 5 Keeper of the Archive.

WANT MORE?

Five new claims every day, free, at almostlore.com. The Party Pack has 54 more cards you won't find in the daily game, stamp sets for eight players and four ways to play.

HOW TO PRINT

- Print at **actual size / 100%** on US Letter. Card stock (200 gsm / 110 lb) survives a lot of slamming; plain paper works too.
- Claim cards come in pairs of pages: **fronts, then backs**. Print them double-sided and **flip on the long edge**; each back lines up behind its front.
- No double-sided printer? Print the fronts only and keep the Answer Book at the back of this file on the table: every answer is there.
- Cut along the grey crop marks. A paper trimmer makes it a ten-minute job.

NO. 01 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

In 1896 Britain and Zanzibar fought a war that lasted less than an hour.

WAR • 1896

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 02 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

A Japanese soldier kept fighting World War II in the Philippine jungle until 1974.

WAR • 1944–1974

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 03 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

Quebec voted to leave Canada in 1995.

POLITICS • 1995

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 04 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

Napoleon Bonaparte was unusually short.

WAR • 1769–1821

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 05 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

When Skylab fell to Earth, an Australian town fined NASA for littering.

SPACE • 1979

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 06 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

The Declaration of Independence was signed by the Continental Congress on July 4, 1776.

POLITICS • 1776

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 07 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

Paul Revere rode through the Massachusetts countryside shouting "The British are coming!"

WAR • 1775

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 08 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

The US Senate removed President Andrew Johnson from office in 1868.

POLITICS • 1868

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 09 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

Aaron Burr was elected president of the United States in 1800.

POLITICS • 1800–1801

ALMOSTLORE.COM

 NO. 03	● HAPPENED NO. 02	● HAPPENED NO. 01
<i>It almost happened.</i> On 30 October 1995, Quebecers voted on sovereignty. The No side won by 50.58% to 49.42%, a margin of 54,288 votes out of more than 4.6 million valid ballots, on a turnout of 93.5%. Sources: 1995 Quebec referendum (Wikipedia) · Quebec Referendum (1995) (The Canadian Encyclopedia)	<i>It really happened.</i> Lieutenant Hiroo Onoda refused to believe the war was over and held out on Lubang Island for 29 years. He surrendered only when his former commanding officer flew out and formally relieved him of duty. Sources: Hiroo Onoda (Wikipedia)	<i>It really happened.</i> On 27 August 1896 British warships shelled the palace of Sultan Khalid bin Barghash after an ultimatum expired. The fighting ended in roughly 38 to 45 minutes, usually called the shortest war on record. Sources: Anglo-Zanzibar War (Wikipedia) · Anniversary of the Shortest War in Human History: the Anglo-Zanzibar War (British Online Archives)
* LORE NO. 06	● HAPPENED NO. 05	* LORE NO. 04
<i>It's lore.</i> Congress approved the wording on July 4, but most delegates signed the engrossed parchment copy on August 2, 1776. Several signed later still. WHERE THE STORY COMES FROM July 4 appears on the document and became the celebrated date, so the signing was folded into it. Jefferson and Adams later misremembered it too. Sources: United States Declaration of Independence (Wikipedia)	<i>It really happened.</i> Debris from the falling space station landed around Esperance, Western Australia, in July 1979. The shire issued a \$400 littering fine, which went unpaid until an American radio host raised the money in 2009. Sources: Skylab (Wikipedia) · First fine for littering from space (Guinness World Records)	<i>It's lore.</i> Napoleon was about 5 feet 7 inches (1.69 m), average or slightly above for a Frenchman of his time. His height was recorded in French inches, which were longer than English ones. WHERE THE STORY COMES FROM British caricaturists such as James Gillray drew him tiny, and the confusion between French and English inches made it stick. Sources: Napoleon (Wikipedia) · Was Napoleon Short? Origins of the 'Napoleon Complex' (HISTORY)
● ALMOST NO. 09	● ALMOST NO. 08	* LORE NO. 07
<i>It almost happened.</i> Burr tied Thomas Jefferson with 73 electoral votes each, which threw the election to the House of Representatives. It took 36 ballots in February 1801 before Jefferson won. Sources: 1800 United States presidential election (Wikipedia) · Electoral College & Indecisive Elections (US House of Representatives: History, Art & Archives)	<i>It almost happened.</i> The House impeached Johnson, and the Senate voted 35 to 19 to convict him. That was one vote short of the two-thirds needed, so he finished his term. Sources: Impeachment of Andrew Johnson (Wikipedia) · The Impeachment of Andrew Johnson (1868) (United States Senate)	<i>It's lore.</i> The ride depended on secrecy, and many colonists still thought of themselves as British. Witnesses recalled the warning as 'The Regulars are coming out.' Revere was also captured before reaching Concord. WHERE THE STORY COMES FROM Henry Wadsworth Longfellow's 1860 poem 'Paul Revere's Ride' created the dramatic lone rider the story is remembered by. Sources: Paul Revere (Wikipedia) · The Real Story of Paul Revere's Ride (Paul Revere House)

NO. 10 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

Winston Churchill won the Nobel Prize in Literature.

LITERATURE • 1953

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 11 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

The Eiffel Tower was pulled down in 1909 when its original 20-year permit ran out.

ARCHITECTURE • 1909

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 12 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

Teaching at Oxford University began before the Aztecs founded their capital, Tenochtitlan.

CULTURE • 1096 / 1325

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 13 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

In World War II a brown bear was enlisted in the Polish army, complete with a rank and a service number.

ANIMALS • 1942–1945

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 14 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

The Great Wall of China can be seen from the Moon with the naked eye.

ARCHITECTURE • MODERN

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 15 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

The crew of Apollo 13 landed on the Moon in April 1970.

SPACE • 1970

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 16 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

Nintendo started out in 1889 making playing cards.

BUSINESS • 1889

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 17 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

Albert Einstein failed mathematics at school.

SCIENCE • 1890S

ALMOSTLORE.COM

NO. 18 • STARTER DECK



HAPPENED, ALMOST, OR LORE?

Mahatma Gandhi won the Nobel Peace Prize.

POLITICS • 1937–1948

ALMOSTLORE.COM

● HAPPENED NO. 12 <i>It really happened.</i> There is evidence of teaching at Oxford by 1096, and the university grew rapidly from 1167. The Mexica founded Tenochtitlan on an island in Lake Texcoco in about 1325. Sources: University of Oxford (Wikipedia) · Tenochtitlan (Wikipedia)	◌ ALMOST NO. 11 <i>It almost happened.</i> The tower was built for the 1889 Exposition, and Eiffel's permit ran for 20 years. It survived because it proved useful for radio and wireless telegraphy, and the concession was renewed. Sources: Eiffel Tower (Wikipedia) · How the Eiffel Tower Was Saved From Being Demolished (HISTORY)	● HAPPENED NO. 10 <i>It really happened.</i> The Swedish Academy awarded Churchill the 1953 Nobel Prize in Literature for his historical and biographical writing and his oratory. He never won the Peace Prize. Sources: Winston Churchill (Wikipedia) · The Nobel Prize in Literature 1953 (The Nobel Prize (NobelPrize.org))
◌ ALMOST NO. 15 <i>It almost happened.</i> Apollo 13 was bound for the Fra Mauro highlands when an oxygen tank exploded two days out. The crew swung around the Moon in their lunar module and splashed down safely, without landing. Sources: Apollo 13 (Wikipedia)	* LORE NO. 14 <i>It's lore.</i> The wall is long but only a few metres wide, roughly the colour of the land around it. It cannot be seen from the Moon, and astronauts in low Earth orbit report it is very hard to see at all without aid. WHERE THE STORY COMES FROM The idea was in print long before spaceflight, from a 1754 letter by antiquary William Stukeley to a 1932 Ripley's cartoon, and has outlasted Apollo astronauts' reports that no human structure is visible from the Moon. Sources: Great Wall of China (Wikipedia) · Great Wall (NASA)	● HAPPENED NO. 13 <i>It really happened.</i> Polish soldiers adopted Wojtek as a cub in Iran in 1942 and signed him up so he could travel with them; he ended the war a corporal. Stories of him hauling shell crates at Monte Cassino made him the unit's emblem, though accounts differ on whether the crates were full. Sources: Wojtek (bear) (Wikipedia) · Wojtek the Bear: Surprising World War II Animal Hero (TIME)
◌ ALMOST NO. 18 <i>It almost happened.</i> Gandhi was nominated five times. In 1947 the Nobel committee split three to two against him; after his murder in January 1948 it seriously weighed a posthumous award, then gave no peace prize that year. Sources: Mahatma Gandhi (Wikipedia) · Mahatma Gandhi, the missing laureate (NobelPrize.org)	* LORE NO. 17 <i>It's lore.</i> Einstein excelled at maths and had mastered calculus by about 15. He did fail the general section of an entrance exam to the Zurich Polytechnic at 16, while scoring well in maths and physics. WHERE THE STORY COMES FROM A 'Ripley's Believe It or Not!' column ran the headline 'Greatest living mathematician failed in mathematics'; shown in 1935, Einstein denied it. Sources: Albert Einstein (Wikipedia) · Making the Grade - 20 Things You Need to Know About Einstein (TIME)	● HAPPENED NO. 16 <i>It really happened.</i> Fusajiro Yamauchi founded Nintendo Koppai in Kyoto in 1889 to make handmade hanafuda playing cards. Its first home video game machines arrived in 1977, 88 years later. Sources: Nintendo (Wikipedia) · Company History (Nintendo)

ANSWER BOOK

01 ● HAPPENED

WAR • 1896

In 1896 Britain and Zanzibar fought a war that lasted less than an hour.

On 27 August 1896 British warships shelled the palace of Sultan Khalid bin Barghash after an ultimatum expired. The fighting ended in roughly 38 to 45 minutes, usually called the shortest war on record.

Anglo-Zanzibar War - Wikipedia - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Anglo-Zanzibar_War
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02 ● HAPPENED

WAR • 1944–1974

A Japanese soldier kept fighting World War II in the Philippine jungle until 1974.

Lieutenant Hiroo Onoda refused to believe the war was over and held out on Lubang Island for 29 years. He surrendered only when his former commanding officer flew out and formally relieved him of duty.

Hiroo Onoda - Wikipedia - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hiroo_Onoda

03 ◐ ALMOST

POLITICS • 1995

Quebec voted to leave Canada in 1995.

On 30 October 1995, Quebecers voted on sovereignty. The No side won by 50.58% to 49.42%, a margin of 54,288 votes out of more than 4.6 million valid ballots, on a turnout of 93.5%.

1995 Quebec referendum - Wikipedia - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1995_Quebec_referendum
Quebec Referendum (1995) - The Canadian Encyclopedia - <https://www.thecanadianencyclopedia.ca/en/article/quebec-referendum-1995>

04 * LORE

WAR • 1769–1821

Napoleon Bonaparte was unusually short.

Napoleon was about 5 feet 7 inches (1.69 m), average or slightly above for a Frenchman of his time. His height was recorded in French inches, which were longer than English ones.

Where the story comes from: British caricaturists such as James Gillray drew him tiny, and the confusion between French and English inches made it stick.

Napoleon - Wikipedia - <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Napoleon>
Was Napoleon Short? Origins of the 'Napoleon Complex' - HISTORY - <https://www.history.com/articles/napoleon-complex-short>

05 ● HAPPENED

SPACE • 1979

When Skylab fell to Earth, an Australian town fined NASA for littering.

Debris from the falling space station landed around Esperance, Western Australia, in July 1979. The shire issued a \$400 littering fine, which went unpaid until an American radio host raised the money in 2009.

Skylab - Wikipedia - <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Skylab>
First fine for littering from space - Guinness World Records - <https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/114725-first-fine-for>

06 * LORE

POLITICS • 1776

The Declaration of Independence was signed by the Continental Congress on July 4, 1776.

Congress approved the wording on July 4, but most delegates signed the engrossed parchment copy on August 2, 1776. Several signed later still.

Where the story comes from: July 4 appears on the document and became the celebrated date, so the signing was folded into it. Jefferson and Adams later misremembered it too.

United States Declaration of Independence - Wikipedia - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/United_States_Declaration_of_Independence

07 * LORE

WAR • 1775

Paul Revere rode through the Massachusetts countryside shouting 'The British are coming!'

The ride depended on secrecy, and many colonists still thought of themselves as British. Witnesses recalled the warning as 'The Regulars are coming out.' Revere was also captured before reaching Concord.

Where the story comes from: Henry Wadsworth Longfellow's 1860 poem 'Paul Revere's Ride' created the dramatic lone rider the story is remembered by.

Paul Revere - Wikipedia - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Paul_Revere
The Real Story of Paul Revere's Ride - Paul Revere House - <https://www.paulreverehouse.org/the-real-story/>

08 ◐ ALMOST

POLITICS • 1868

The US Senate removed President Andrew Johnson from office in 1868.

The House impeached Johnson, and the Senate voted 35 to 19 to convict him. That was one vote short of the two-thirds needed, so he finished his term.

Impeachment of Andrew Johnson - Wikipedia - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Impeachment_of_Andrew_Johnson
The Impeachment of Andrew Johnson (1868) - United States Senate - <https://www.senate.gov/about/powers-procedures/impeachment/impeachment-johnson.htm>

09 ◐ ALMOST

POLITICS • 1800–1801

Aaron Burr was elected president of the United States in 1800.

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Electoral College & Indecisive Elections - US House of Representatives: History, Art & Archives - <https://history.house.gov/Institution/Origins-Development/Electoral-College/>

10 ● HAPPENED

LITERATURE • 1953

Winston Churchill won the Nobel Prize in Literature.

The Swedish Academy awarded Churchill the 1953 Nobel Prize in Literature for his historical and biographical writing and his oratory. He never won the Peace Prize.

Winston Churchill - Wikipedia - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Winston_Churchill

ANSWER BOOK

11 ALMOST

ARCHITECTURE • 1909

The Eiffel Tower was pulled down in 1909 when its original 20-year permit ran out.

The tower was built for the 1889 Exposition, and Eiffel's permit ran for 20 years. It survived because it proved useful for radio and wireless telegraphy, and the concession was renewed.

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 How the Eiffel Tower Was Saved From Being Demolished – HISTORY – <https://www.history.com/articles/eiffel-tower-survival>

12 HAPPENED

CULTURE • 1096 / 1325

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University of Oxford – Wikipedia – https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/University_of_Oxford
 Tenochtitlan – Wikipedia – <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tenochtitlan>

13 HAPPENED

ANIMALS • 1942–1945

In World War II a brown bear was enlisted in the Polish army, complete with a rank and a service number.

Polish soldiers adopted Wojtek as a cub in Iran in 1942 and signed him up so he could travel with them; he ended the war a corporal. Stories of him hauling shell crates at Monte Cassino made him the unit's emblem, though accounts differ on whether the crates were full.

Wojtek (bear) – Wikipedia – [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Wojtek_\(bear\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Wojtek_(bear))
 Wojtek the Bear: Surprising World War II Animal Hero – TIME – <https://time.com/4731787/wojtek-the-bear-history/>

14 LORE

ARCHITECTURE • MODERN

The Great Wall of China can be seen from the Moon with the naked eye.

The wall is long but only a few metres wide, roughly the colour of the land around it. It cannot be seen from the Moon, and astronauts in low Earth orbit report it is very hard to see at all without aid.

Where the story comes from: The idea was in print long before space flight, from a 1754 letter by antiquary William Stukeley to a 1932 Ripley's cartoon, and has outlasted Apollo astronauts' reports that no human structure is visible from the Moon.

Great Wall of China – Wikipedia – https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Great_Wall_of_China
 Great Wall – NASA – <https://www.nasa.gov/image-article/great-wall/>

15 ALMOST

SPACE • 1970

The crew of Apollo 13 landed on the Moon in April 1970.

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16 HAPPENED

BUSINESS • 1889

Nintendo started out in 1889 making playing cards.

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Nintendo – Wikipedia – <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nintendo>
 Company History – Nintendo – <https://www.nintendo.co.jp/corporate/en/history/index.html>

17 LORE

SCIENCE • 1890S

Albert Einstein failed mathematics at school.

Einstein excelled at maths and had mastered calculus by about 15. He did fail the general section of an entrance exam to the Zurich Polytechnic at 16, while scoring well in maths and physics.

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Albert Einstein – Wikipedia – https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Albert_Einstein
 Making the Grade - 20 Things You Need to Know About Einstein – TIME – https://content.time.com/time/specials/packages/article/0,28804,1936731_1936743_1936758,00.html

18 ALMOST

POLITICS • 1937–1948

Mahatma Gandhi won the Nobel Peace Prize.

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Mahatma Gandhi – Wikipedia – https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mahatma_Gandhi
 Mahatma Gandhi, the missing laureate – NobelPrize.org – <https://www.nobelprize.org/prizes/themes/mahatma-gandhi-the-missing-laureate/>

COLOPHON

LICENCE

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